Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Saturday, 31 October 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Mostly clear	Fog	Overcast	Light drizzle
15° 10°	13° 8°	13° 7°	15° 10°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Police Scotland are actively investigating visits made by Prince Andrew to Balmoral with convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein.**

The force confirmed they have received information regarding the visits and stressed that their inquiries are currently at an early stage. This comes after years of speculation and public interest in the Duke of York's association with Epstein.

CRIME · UK

2 **A driver has been found guilty of murdering head teacher Michael Mullins, who was tragically dragged to his death.**

Simon Richardson was convicted of the killing and is now awaiting sentencing, which is scheduled for Monday. The case has deeply shocked the community, bringing a tragic end to the life of a respected educator.

CRIME · UK

3 **Ministers are pledging swift action on online safety following the heartbreaking death of a teenager who was a victim of sextortion.**

Cai Davies took his own life after sending messages to a woman he believed had a romantic interest in him. The case highlights the urgent need for stronger protections against online exploitation.

ONLINE SAFETY · UK

4 **Two men have been jailed for their 'abhorrent' role in a sophisticated operation trafficking women from Europe into the UK for sex work.**

George Filip led a substantial crime group that exploited at least 16 victims. The court heard details of the harrowing conditions and coercion faced by the women involved.

CRIME · UK

5 **The Met Police are facing an investigation by the police watchdog over their handling of a letter containing allegations about Meghan's father.**

This probe will examine the force's procedures and decisions regarding the sensitive information. It adds to ongoing scrutiny of the Met's operations and public accountability.

POLICE · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **The Traitors is set for a bombshell confession as the faithfuls finally start to turn the screw on Thursday's penultimate episode!**

Fans are on the edge of their seats wondering if the faithfuls can finally uncover the traitors and come good in this nail-biting series. It's been a season full of twists, turns, and incredible gameplay.

ON AIR — Who do you think will be unmasked as a traitor in the final episodes?

TV · TONIGHT

2 **The illustrator of the beloved Gruffalo books, Axel Scheffler, is considering legal action against AI firms.**

He believes these companies are breaching copyright by reproducing his distinctive work to create AI-generated Gruffalo images. This raises big questions about intellectual property in the age of artificial intelligence.

ON AIR — Should AI companies be allowed to use existing artwork to train their systems without permission?

BOOKS · FUTURE

3 **A new piece explores how Bristol shaped Maya Jama before she became a household name and host of Love Island.**

It delves into her journey from leaving her hometown as a teenager to reaching the grand final of one of the biggest shows on television. It's a fascinating look at her rise to fame.

ON AIR — Which TV presenter's journey to stardom do you find most inspiring?

TV · TODAY

4 **Former Top Gear host Richard Hammond is embracing a 'brave' new Welsh life, enjoying wild swimming and running.**

The much-loved presenter bought a 19th-century Georgian mansion near Abergavenny last November. It sounds like he's traded fast cars for a more tranquil, outdoorsy existence!

ON AIR — If you could swap your life for a celebrity's, who would it be and what would you do?

TV · NOW

5 **Dedicated ACOTAR fans are putting real life on hold this week to dive into the latest release from the fantasy series.**

Some devoted readers have even taken time off work to fully immerse themselves in the new instalment of 'A Court of Thorns and Roses'. That's true dedication to a book series!

ON AIR — What book or series has ever made you want to drop everything and just read?

BOOKS · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **Eddie Howe is being strongly linked with the Manchester United job, sparking debate about what he could bring to Old Trafford.**

Speculation is rife about whether the current Newcastle manager would be a good fit for the Red Devils. Fans are weighing up the challenges and potential benefits of such a move.

ON AIR — Do you think Eddie Howe is the right person to turn things around at Manchester United?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **The decisive Test between South Africa and Australia is set for a classic finale, promising an epic final day of cricket.**

South Africa batted throughout the fourth day, setting up a thrilling conclusion to the series. History suggests this could go right down to the wire, making for unmissable viewing.

ON AIR — What's the most nail-biting sporting finale you've ever watched?

CRICKET · GLOBAL

3 **Is it 'now or never' for Britain's first £100m man, Jack Grealish, after he was dropped by Everton?**

The chief football writer Phil McNulty asks if this is a defining moment for Grealish, who was benched for a breach of club discipline. It's a critical point in his career.

ON AIR — Can Jack Grealish recapture his best form and prove his worth at Everton?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **Alexander Zverev has thrashed Britain's Arthur Fery to reach the semi-finals of the Vienna Open, marking his rise to world number one.**

It was a dominant victory for Zverev, showcasing why he's now at the top of the tennis world. Fery put up a fight but couldn't overcome the top seed.

ON AIR — Who is your favourite tennis player to watch right now, and why?

TENNIS · GLOBAL

5 **Tottenham midfielder James Maddison is fit to face Crystal Palace on Saturday, according to manager Roberto De Zerbi.**

This is great news for Spurs fans after an injury scare last week. Maddison's return will be a huge boost as they look to continue their strong start to the season.

ON AIR — Which player's return from injury would make the biggest difference to your team?

FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A new study suggests that the subtle scent of 'freshly cut grass' can significantly reduce stress levels.**
   Researchers found that participants exposed to the natural aroma reported feeling calmer and more relaxed, hinting at nature's simple power to soothe us.

2. **The surprising trend of 'collecting unique pebbles' from local beaches and rivers is gaining popularity among all ages.**
   People are showcasing their smoothed, colourful finds in decorative bowls, celebrating the simple beauty of natural geology.

3. **Experts are highlighting the unexpected joy of 'mastering a new knot' in everyday situations, from tying shoelaces to securing parcels.**
   There's a quiet satisfaction in a well-tied knot, turning a mundane task into a moment of practical skill.

4. **The humble 'wooden spoon' is being celebrated as the unsung hero of the kitchen in a recent online poll.**
   Its versatility, gentle touch on cookware, and comforting feel have earned it top marks from home cooks across the country.

5. **There's a growing appreciation for the delicate art of 'creating a perfect ripple in a cup of tea' with a gentle stir.**
   This small, mindful moment is being seen as a tiny ritual of calm before enjoying a warming brew.

6. **Many are discovering the charm of 'spotting friendly faces in cloud formations' on a sunny afternoon.**
   It's a delightful way to reconnect with imagination and find wonder in the ever-changing sky.

7. **The simple pleasure of 'hearing the satisfying click of a light switch' when entering a room is bringing a subtle sense of order.**
   It's a small, reassuring sound that signals a moment of arrival or departure in our daily routines.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when trying to decide if a new kind of cheese will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GIVING IT A VERY SERIOUS, KNOWING SNIFF, AS IF WE'RE A PROFESSIONAL CHEESE TASTER!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of soap, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: UNWRAPPING IT VERY, VERY SLOWLY TO FULLY APPRECIATE THE SCENT, ALMOST LIKE OPENING A PRECIOUS GIFT!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday object' just looks incredibly happy or surprised, thanks to its design?**
  It might be a plug socket, a garden gnome, or even a cloud that seems to have a cheerful expression. What everyday objects do you spot that always seem to be smiling, or pulling a funny face?

- **We all have that 'one particular piece of clothing' that we absolutely adore, even if it's a bit old or faded.**
  Perhaps it's a cosy jumper, a lucky pair of socks, or a well-loved scarf. What's your go-to comfort clothing item, and what makes it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** The 'quokka', a small marsupial native to Australia, is often called the 'world's happiest animal' because of its perpetually smiling facial expression.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Penguins are the only birds that can both fly and swim, using their wings to propel themselves through water.

Prepflow

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is collectively known as a 'parliament'.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are over 3,000 years old and still edible.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents.
- The national animal of Scotland is the unicorn.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- There are more fake flamingos in the world than real ones.
- The word 'hello' was originally a greeting to call attention, like 'hey there!'

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES SAT 31 OCT 2026

On this day

Day 304 of the year, 61 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Alphonsus Rodriguez; Christian feast day: Ampliatus; Christian feast day: Begu; Christian feast day: Blessed Dominic Collins. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Opal.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1941 — Sally Kirkland, American actress (died 2025)
- 1939 — Ron Rifkin, American actor
- 1976 — Piper Perabo, American actress and producer
- 1975 — Johnny Whitworth, American actor and producer
- 1997 — Marcus Rashford, English footballer
- 1948 — Michael Kitchen, English actor and producer
- 1967 — Vanilla Ice, American rapper, television personality, and real estate investor
- 1945 — Russ Ballard, English singer-songwriter and guitarist

THE DAY TODAY

- 1979 — Western Airlines Flight 2605 crashes on landing in Mexico City, killing 73 people.
- 1999 — Yachtsman Jesse Martin returns to Melbourne after 11 months of circumnavigating the world, solo, non-stop and unassisted.
- 1968 — Great Drought of 1968: Amidst a collapse of hydropower President of Chile Eduardo Frei Montalva decrees the establishment of daylight saving time.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1996 — TAM Transportes Aéreos Regionais Flight 402 crashes in São Paulo, Brazil, killing 99 people.
- 1999 — Yachtsman Jesse Martin returns to Melbourne after 11 months of circumnavigating the world, solo, non-stop and unassisted.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1956 — Suez Crisis: The United Kingdom and France begin bombing Egypt to force the reopening of the Suez Canal.
- 1963 — Indiana State Fairgrounds Coliseum gas explosion: A gas explosion at the Indiana State Fairgrounds Coliseum in Indianapolis kills 81 people and injures another 400 during an ice show.

- 1956 — Hungarian Revolution of 1956: A Revolutionary Headquarters is established in Hungary. Following Imre Nagy's announcement of October 30, banned non-Communist political parties are reformed, and the MDP is replaced by the MSZMP. József Mindszenty is released from prison. The So...

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES SUN 1 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 305 of the year, 60 days left in 2026. Today All Saints' Day, a holy day of obligation in some areas (a national holiday in many historically Catholic countries), and its related observance: Day of the Innocents, The first day of Day of the Dead or El Dia de los Muertos celebration. (Mexico, Haiti); Anniversary of the Revolution (Algeria); Chavang Kut (Mizo people of Northeast India, Bangladesh, Burma); Chhattisgarh Rajyotsava (Chhattisgarh, India). Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- **1959 — Susanna Clarke, English author and educator**
- **1979 — Alex Prager, American photographer and director**
- **1963 — Big Kenny, American singer-songwriter and guitarist**
- **1949 — Jeannie Berlin, American actress**
- **1955 — Beth Leavel, American actress and singer**
- **1958 — Mark Austin, English journalist**
- **1972 — Jenny McCarthy, American actress and model**
- **1941 — John Pullin, English rugby player (died 2021)**

THE DAY TOMORROW

- **2009 — An Ilyushin Il-76 crashes near the Mir mine after takeoff from Mirny Airport in Yakutia, killing all 11 aboard.**
- **1979 — Griselda Álvarez becomes the first female governor of a state of Mexico.**
- **1976 — Burundian president Michel Micombero is deposed in a bloodless military coup d'état by deputy Jean-Baptiste Bagaza.**

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- **2012 — A fuel tank truck crashes and explodes in the Saudi Arabian capital Riyadh, killing 26 people and injuring 135.**
- **1981 — Antigua and Barbuda gains independence from the United Kingdom.**

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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